

For sale of
April 1853. 871f

A FEMALE CRUSOE.

SANTA BARBARA, CAL., Sept. 11, 1853.

We have now in Santa Barbara a great curiosity; it is an Indian woman, who has lived for eighteen years alone upon the island of San Nicholas—a small island about forty-five miles from this place—during which time she has not seen the face of a human being. This island was once peopled by a tribe of Indians, to whom the Northwest tribes were hostile. To preserve the remnant of this tribe from destruction, as well as with a view to christianize them, the Padres induced them to come to the main land eighteen years ago. After they were all on board the vessel sent for them, this woman swam ashore to look for her child which had been left; and a storm springing up in the night the vessel was compelled to put to sea; on returning, she could not be found. She was known to be alive, by those who at times visited the island for the purpose of hunting otters, from the marks of fires and foot-prints in the sand.

On being approached the other day, she manifested much joy, which she betrayed by signs of the most significant character, and at once commenced packing up her few articles of furniture. Whether the sounds which she utters are words or not has not yet been ascertained. The man who found her is familiar with five or six Indian languages, but he was unable to understand a single expression; it is more than probable that she has forgotten her native tongue entirely. Her clothing consisted of skins of birds sewed together with the fibres of some trees or plant. Her food has been shell-fish, seals, and a small bulbous root, similar in appearance to an onion, but wholly tasteless. The needles with which she stitches her garments are made of the sharp bones of a fish. She had two hooks made of a bent nail and sharp-

She had two hooks made of a bent nail, and sharpened by friction upon a stone. Her lines were beautifully twisted from the sinews of some animal probably a species of fox which abounds on the island.

Her age, as near as can be estimated, is about 55 or 60. Her features are quite masculine, and her hair of the color of dark brown, and very fine. This is quite remarkable for an Indian; their hair, you know, is always jet black and coarse. In some future letter I will give you a more extended account of this marvel of the nineteenth century. She is truly an object for the reflection of the philosopher and the inspection of the curious.—*Newburyport Herald*.